

I Can't Sleep / I Woke Up in the Middle of the Night

If you can't sleep and you're up in the middle of the night with insomnia and racing thoughts, I wanna remind you the racing thoughts are not the problem you need to solve right now. The thoughts are loud because your system is very activated. Your thoughts are being driven by your sensitized nervous system.

They feel really urgent because your nervous system is making everything feel urgent. They're not true just because they're very loud. They don't require your engagement just because they showed up. Something that I always told myself when I was up in the middle of the night with insomnia and freaking out.

We don't need to do any more thinking today. We can think tomorrow. You do not have to figure anything out tonight. There is no thought that needs to be resolved before you can rest. There is no loop that needs to be closed right now. And normally what keeps people awake isn't necessarily the thoughts themselves, it's the engagement with the thoughts because all of the arguing or reasoning or convincing or trying to think your way to safety, the self reassurance, it just drives up the alarm even more.

And, and none of it sticks. So here's what you're gonna do. Nothing. You let the thoughts be there. Do not grab onto them. Do not push them away. Do not argue with them. Stop participating. Your body is activated. That's allowed to be there too. You're not going to clench against it or hold your breath waiting for it to pass.

Practice in this moment softening even just a little. You may not fall asleep right away. That's okay. You don't need to fall asleep to be okay. You can just lay there not sleeping and still be resting more than you would if you were fighting this the whole time. I wanna remind you that you have survived every single night like this before.

You've had terrible sleep and you still function the next day. Your brain is telling you, tomorrow will be a disaster if you don't sleep. But that again is just the fear talking. That's not a fact. So just for now, just for tonight, let go of needing to sleep. Let go of needing the thoughts to stop, let go of needing to calm down and just lay there.

Just rest soft, non-engaged, and let time pass if you want a deeper understanding of acceptance, especially when it comes to situations like insomnia. That would be lesson seven or eight for allowing and not engaging. You can refer back to lessons nine and 10, and you can do that tomorrow after you rest.

We're gonna stop working on this. There's nothing to solve tonight. I.